



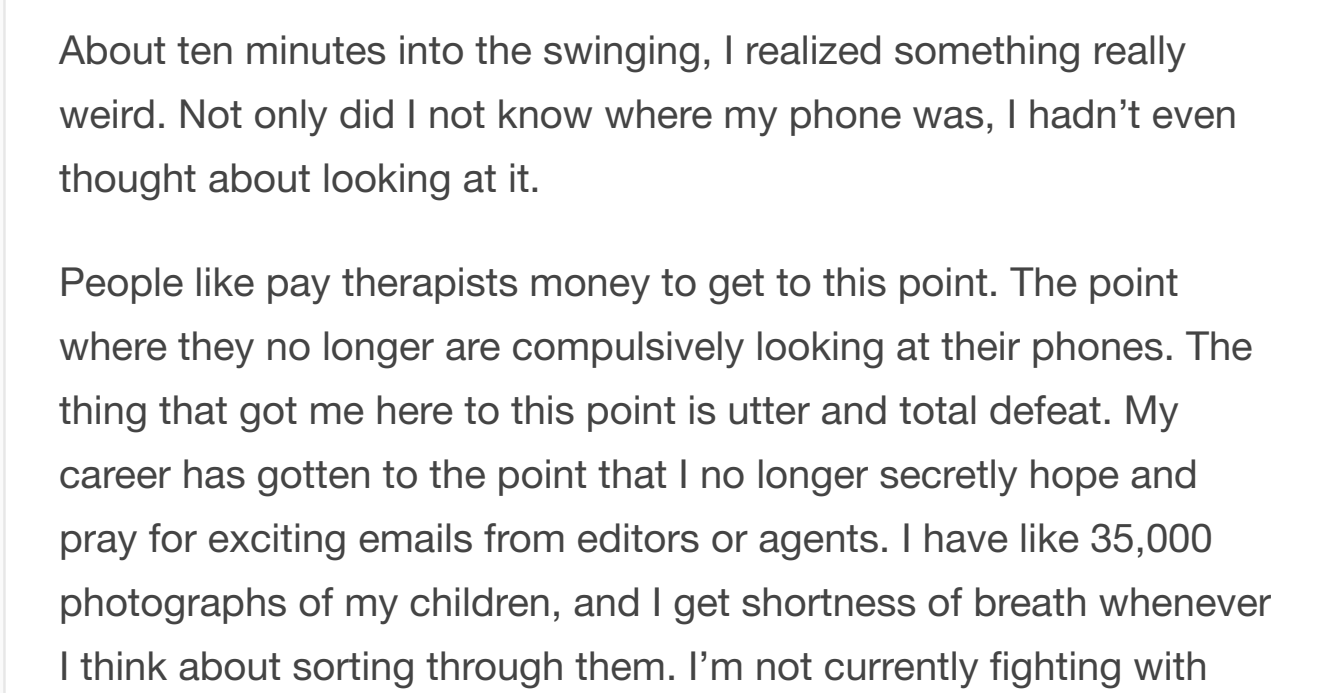
A Brie Grows in Brooklyn

"Mabel's not crazy.... she's unusual."

POSTS LIKES ASK ME ANYTHING SUBMIT ARCHIVE

I'm Not Mary, Mother of God, But That Bitch Only Had One Child

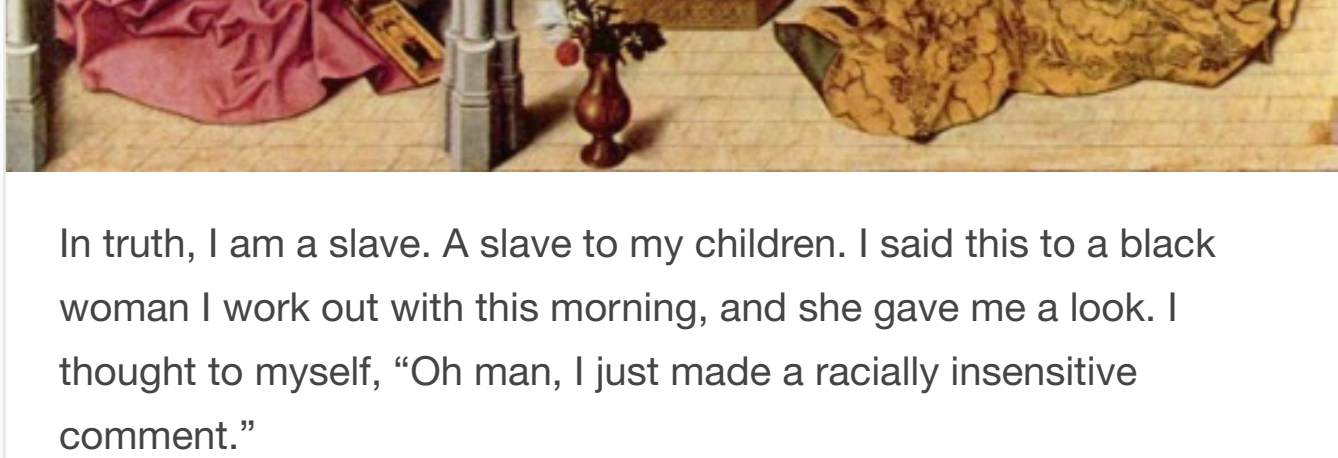
Yesterday, I was pushing my children on the swings in Carroll Park, the most highly populated local park in our neighborhood. A really nice nanny had moved the child in her care to a swing further away so that my children could swing next to each other. Our gigantic stroller packed with shit was at a safe, but visible, distance away.



About ten minutes into the swinging, I realized something really weird. Not only did I not know where my phone was, I hadn't even thought about looking at it.

People like pay therapists money to get to this point. The point where they no longer are compulsively looking at their phones. The thing that got me here to this point is utter and total defeat. My career has gotten to the point that I no longer secretly hope and pray for exciting emails from editors or agents. I have like 35,000 photographs of my children, and I get shortness of breath whenever I think about sorting through them. I'm not currently fighting with anyone, so I'm not waiting for any text messages that will fuel the delicious perverse pleasure I get from crafting a strongly worded explication of my feelings. I have lost expectations that my personal life will in any way improve or change, so I am able to be totally and completely with my children.

This is something people with billions of dollars purport to want, but I have gotten to this place because I am a loser.



In truth, I am a slave. A slave to my children. I said this to a black woman I work out with this morning, and she gave me a look. I thought to myself, "Oh man, I just made a racially insensitive comment."

But instead, she said to me, "Girl, I'm with you." She has two kids herself, and knows exactly what the fuck I mean.

I wake up in the morning, and I have twenty minutes alone before I go work out. Then my duties begin. If I am not walking back and forth from the couch to the refrigerator to the washing machine to the bathroom to the changing table, then I am on my fucking hands and knees scrubbing some bodily fluid off the places where my children tread their feet.

There is no time for me. There is no me. In order to keep our apartment smelling, at the very least, neutral, I must clean from the moment my kids wake up until the moment they go to sleep. I also cook, read, perform, sing and produce milk, sometimes simultaneously.



Yesterday, Caleb go home from work. He asked how my day was, and I said that I hung out with the mother of one of Cleo's classmates at French school. She is French, she has long black hair, and always sports a smokey eye. She loves to have long conversations about the television shows she's watching. I really, really like her. I can't believe a French person likes me too!

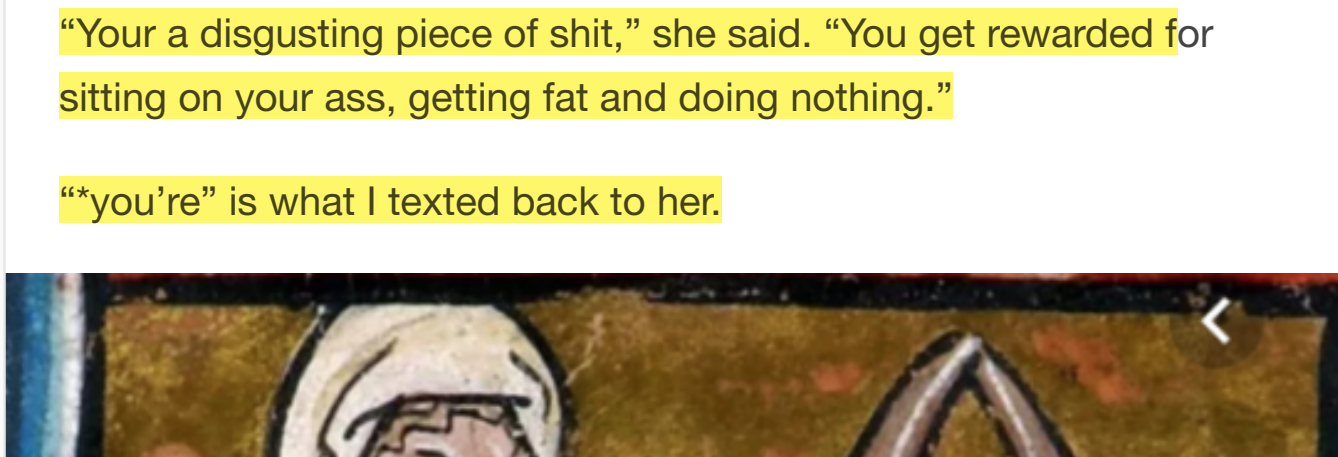
"What do you guys talk about, what your husbands or partners do?" Caleb asked me when I relayed to him that I had gone to the playground with this French friend.

And he was not joking. He was completely serious. I am working harder than I ever have in my entire life, like by a fucking long shot, and when my husband looks at my day, he sees a blank void filled only by his own career.

When my parents said they would help me put a down payment on a house in Chappaqua, the sister closest in age texted me,

"Your a disgusting piece of shit," she said. "You get rewarded for sitting on your ass, getting fat and doing nothing."

"you're" is what I texted back to her,



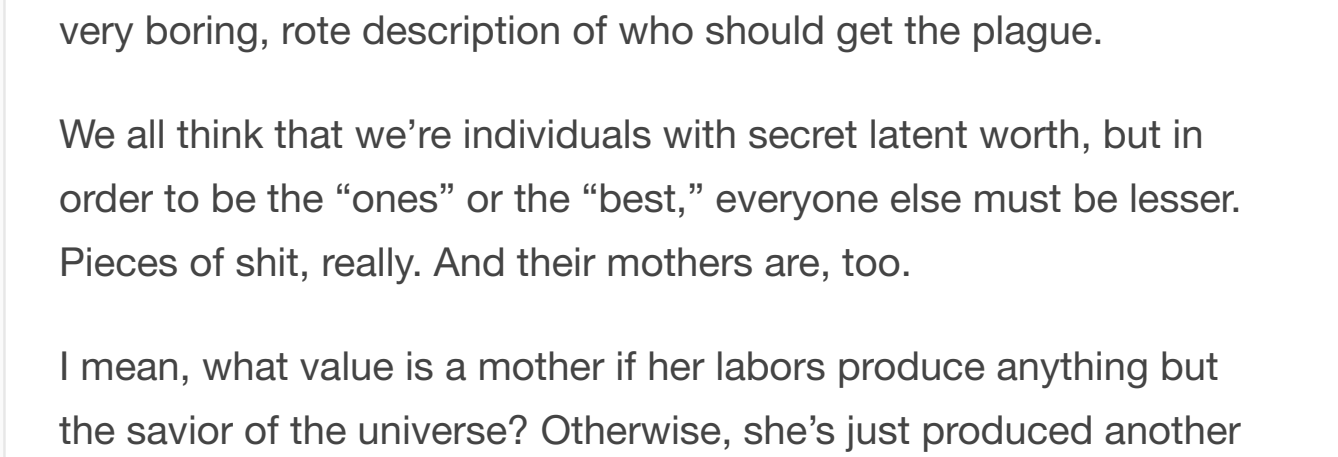
I don't care what she thinks about me. But her text illuminated a truth, and that truth is that now that I've become a mother, even those closest to me actually think that I do nothing all day. That could not be further from the truth, but I'm not sure the perception will ever change.

I thought about why it won't change a little bit during the twenty minutes between when Cass fell asleep with his mouth clamped around my nipple on the couch, and I went to bed myself. Why, despite overwhelming evidence to the contrary, do people still think that women who stay at home with their kids do "nothing"?

Of course, there's a capitalist rationale, in the sense that if you're not getting paid, your labor is literally worthless, blah blah blah blah blah. But there's also something larger at play, and that's the sense that people in general are worthless. The work of a mother is the most important work in the entire world — if you believe that each person is worth the same as every other person, and therefore deserves the presence of a loving and attentive caretaker in their early years. But if you think that most people should be annihilated off the face of the planet because they walk too slowly on the sidewalk, or because they voted for Trump, or because they...what are some bad things people do that make them perfect candidates for the plague? Yelled at you for not putting a hat on your newborn? Refused to have sex with you? Were born fat, skinny, ugly, pretty, gay, straight, nonbinary, trans, or loving avocado toast? This is a very boring, rote description of who should get the plague.

We all think that we're individuals with secret latent worth, but in order to be the "ones" or the "best," everyone else must be lesser. Pieces of shit, really. And their mothers are, too.

I mean, what value is a mother if her labors produce anything but the savior of the universe? Otherwise, she's just produced another content maker, and what's worse is that she hasn't even contributed to Social Security.



In any case, we are a society of individuals, but we do not value the individual at all. So there's something to be said in this about why we don't praise mothers — or fathers, although stay at home fathers usually get praised to the fucking rafters, let's be honest. But I can't think because I'm a slave with about six hours of freedom, during which I have to save my mental strength to write some fucking branded content and make some fucking money, yolo

If you feel under-appreciated, I see you. Not really! I can't see shit. But I'm with you, I guess I mean to say. This morning I listened to a podcast person who has 80 million subscribers talk on WNYC, and I was like, "WHAT DID THAT BITCH DO AND WHY CAN'T THAT BE ME."

#Motherhood #Mary #Mother of God

5 notes Oct 9th, 2019